

- **Antioxidants** including vitamins A, C, and E, selenium, and zinc, help prevent damage to sperm DNA.
- **Selenium** helps to make sperm, improve their motility, and protect against DNA damage. Increase the amount of oily fish you eat, such as mackerel and salmon, and snack on Brazil nuts—these are an unusually rich source of selenium.
- **Zinc** is present in large amounts in semen. Eat fish, lean meat, shellfish, turkey, chicken, eggs, whole grains, rye, and oats.
- **Essential fatty acids** may improve sperm motility, so again eat oily fish as well as seeds and nuts.
- **Use caution with soy** since soy products are high in isoflavones, plant chemicals that mimic estrogen hormones. A high intake may reduce sperm concentration.